

VINCENT VAN DEN BRAKEN

Engineer · 30 years · .NET, C#, Python, JS · Systems, Scale, Craft

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CET/CEST

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// ABOUT

Engineer with **30 years of production experience** spanning full-stack development, cloud infrastructure, systems architecture, and security. Self-taught since 1996 — started building B2B web platforms before "full-stack" was a term, ran my own ISP, and have been shipping code continuously ever since.

Deeply **remote-native** since 2021, **async-first** communicator, and equally comfortable debating architecture in a GitHub issue or debugging a race condition at 2 AM. I care deeply about **code quality, security discipline, and the user experience of the systems I build** — whether that's a SaaS platform serving regulated life-science data or an internal tool that makes my team measurably more productive.

I don't just write code — I **design systems, automate workflows, and obsess over the details** that separate working software from software you can trust with people's data, time, and attention.

30

YEARS SHIPPING

8+

LANGUAGES

100%

REMOTE (5+ yrs)

AI

NATIVE WORKFLOW

// CRAFT & PHILOSOPHY

► On quality and debugging

I treat debugging as the purest form of engineering — you're building a mental model of a system, forming hypotheses, and testing them against reality. Every bug is a gap in your understanding, and closing that gap makes you a better engineer. My approach is systematic: reproduce, isolate, understand the mechanism, fix the root cause, add the regression test, and ask "why wasn't this caught earlier?" The last question is where systemic improvements come from.

► On abstraction

Abstraction is leverage — but every layer of indirection is also a leak surface, a debugging tax, and a cognitive load. I've seen too many codebases where "clean architecture" meant six layers of indirection that made a simple data fetch require opening 14 files. I reach for abstraction when it removes duplication or enables testing, not because it's the fashionable pattern. The right abstraction saves time; the wrong one costs more than it saves, forever.

► On working at scale

Scale isn't just about requests per second — it's about complexity management. At the Belastingdienst (Dutch tax authority), "scale" meant millions of citizens depending on correct data processing with zero tolerance for error. At Rabobank, it meant financial transactions where a bug costs real money. In life sciences (SkinConsult), it meant regulatory compliance where a data leak costs your license. Every one of these environments taught me that scale is a *systemic* property: you can't bolt it on after shipping.

// EXPERIENCE

// CURRENT · Life Sciences Holding – three organizations, one platform vision

Technical Lead · SkinConsult

Dec 2021 – present

C# · .NET · Azure · Blazor · AI workflows · Team lead · Remote

- Solo technical lead for EU-regulatory SaaS platform (cosmetovigilance). Full modernization legacy → AI-native architecture with zero-downtime deploys.
- Built AI-agent workflows as primary delivery method; structural tech-debt reduction alongside feature development.
- Azure infrastructure: App Services, Functions, Service Bus, Key Vault, Aspire, OpenTelemetry.
- Operator discipline: every AI-generated diff validated for tenant isolation, ownership checks, audit trails, and data minimization — the layer generated code silently gets wrong.

Technical Consultant · Allergie Centra Nederland

Jun 2023 – present

Azure · .NET · Cloudflare · GitHub Actions · Azure DevOps

- Technical consultancy on Azure systems: custom integrations, APIs, data pipelines, document workflows.
- Edge + DevOps end-to-end: Cloudflare Workers, DNS, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps YAML pipelines.
- Security-by-design in patient-data context: data boundaries, authorization, audit trails.

Consultant – Azure Integration Services · Rensa Family Company

May 2021 – Nov 2021

Azure Functions · Service Bus · Azure DevOps

- Integrations via Azure Functions and Service Bus; CI/CD pipeline design.

// GOVERNMENT & FINANCE – via Quintor

Technical Team Lead · Belastingdienst (Dutch Tax Authority)

May 2018 – Mar 2019

.NET Core · CI/CD · Test Automation · Team lead

- Lead technical architect for CI/CD and test automation initiative within a government environment serving millions of citizens.
- Built automated testing to replace manual regression — covering ORM behavior, structured logging, and deployment integrity.

Full Stack .NET Developer · Rabobank

Sep 2017 – Apr 2018

.NET MVC · Analysis Services · CI/CD · Peer review

- Rebuilt financial application; introduced pull request peer review as a process improvement.

Senior Developer → Project Development Manager · Deltec Software · True People 1996 – 2021

C# · .NET · Umbraco · CI/CD (Jenkins, Git) · Team leadership

- 21-year arc at Deltec: from trainee to senior developer. Built early B2B web platforms, implemented CI/CD before it was called DevOps.
- Founded RoutIT (1999): customer portal, ticketing, and monitoring systems — first taste of owning infrastructure end-to-end.
- Project Development Manager at True People: Umbraco projects, Scrum, team lead.

// TOOLS & CRAFT

Languages

C# (primary, 25+ yrs) · JavaScript/TypeScript · Python · SQL · HTML/CSS · PHP (some) · Bash

Systems & Scale

Azure (App Svcs, Functions, Service Bus, Key Vault, Aspire) · Docker · K8s · Linux · Microservices · DDD · CQRS

DevOps & CI/CD

Azure DevOps · GitHub Actions · Jenkins · GitOps · Ansible · Bicep · Terraform · OpenTelemetry

Quality & Security

Code review (structured, severity-classified) · NEN 7510 · AVG/GDPR · tenant-isolation · audit trails · automated testing

AI & Automation

AI-agent workflows (since 2024) · LLM orchestration · Machine-readable styleguides · Code generation validation

Infrastructure

Proxmox VE (KVM/LXC, ZFS) · Cloudflare (Workers, DNS) · FreeBSD routing · Home Assistant (200+ devices) · Self-hosting

// HOW I WORK

Async-first, remote-native. 100% remote since 2021. I communicate in writing by default — GitHub issues, PR descriptions, Slack threads, documentation. I believe the best engineering communication is the kind that leaves a permanent record someone can find six months later.

Open source ethos. I've been building on and contributing to open-source ecosystems my entire career — from early PHP CMS platforms to .NET's open-source transformation. I believe in transparent, collaborative development and have structured my teams the same way.

Shipping discipline. Deploy often, review thoroughly, measure everything. I've built CI/CD pipelines that turn a commit-to-production cycle into minutes, not days — but every deploy is peer-reviewed and monitored.

Autonomous, not isolated. I thrive with clear outcomes and the freedom to figure out the path. I check in when there's something to learn, share, or unblock — not because a calendar says so.

// CERTIFICATIONS

Certified ScrumMaster

Scrum Alliance (2018)

AWS Fundamentals

Going Cloud-Native (2020)

Python for Everybody

Univ. of Michigan (2018)

Umbraco Certified

Professional (2019)

// LANGUAGES

- Dutch (native — C2)
- English (C2 — primary written language)
- Spanish (basic)

// AVAILABILITY

- Available August 1, 2026; earlier negotiable
- Open to travel 3–4 weeks/year for team meetups
- CET/CEST timezone, flexible schedule